

MOBBED The Udaipur murder accused were roughed up at the NIA court premises in Jaipur, July 2

ANI

also taken more suspects into custody including those alleged to have been in the know about the plot. Across the state, the police has been booking and arresting people from both communities for circulating videos of Sharma or the murder to instigate violence. Describing the killers, Gaus Mohammad and Mohammad Riyaz, an officer who interrogated the two told INDIA TODAY: "They had no remorse whatsoever for their actions."

The central brief of the NIA investigation and the anti-terrorism squad (ATS) of Rajasthan is to look for clues about whether the two were part of a larger conspiracy to create communal disharmony and how intelligence agencies at the Centre and the state missed out on flagging someone like Gaus Mohammad, who had visited Pakistan for 45 days in 2014 on a visa arranged from that country. Gaus has been to Nepal too and had also gone to Saudi Arabia on Haj as had second accused Mohammad Riyaz in 2019. It is suspected that Kohle's murder in Amravati on June 21 too was motivated by the victim's reported support on social media for Sharma. The investigators are also looking into why Gaus had visited Pakistan in 2014, and whether anyone funded the two men's trips abroad, given that both are from low income families.

THE NIA'S BRIEF IS TO LOOK INTO A POSSIBLE LARGER CONSPIRACY TO CREATE COMMUNAL DISHARMONY BEHIND THE UDAIPUR MURDER

Gaus's father was a collection agent for the Sahara India finance company and after the firm closed set up a small grocery shop in his home, a few hundred metres from the house where Riyaz had shifted two weeks before the murder. Both houses are within sight of a police post and the adjoining mosque at the historic Kishanpole Gate. Gaus, a matriculate, was